

festival

Culture Show

DELHI It's celebration time as India Habitat Centre (IHC) turns 10 this week. Having become one of the most happening addresses in the city, not only for its cultural events but also for its *adda*-like atmosphere which winds its way from the visual art gallery to the splendid food courts and the open air theatre, IHC provides a platform to both performing and visual artistes. The HCL concert series, in particular, launches artistes not only from Delhi but also from faraway districts like Sangli in Maharashtra and Dharwad in Karnataka.

A fortnight-long festival from November 17 to 30 will feature performances in dance, music and theatre. Revisit nostalgia with *Tumhari Amrita*, a play featuring Farooque Sheikh and Shabana Azmi and directed by Feroz Abbas Khan, who also helmed *Gandhi My Father* released this year. The play was first staged at IHC 10 years ago.

On November 25,

watch the confluence of five dance forms—Bharatnatyam, Odissi, Kathakali, Kathak and Manipuri in a presentation called Sankriti, which is choreographed by Odissi dancer Madhavi Mudgal.

On the same day various eminent artistes come together for a workshop to create Habitat-inspired works in and around the amphitheatre, while other performances include dance recitals by Sonal Mansingh and Sharon Lowen (Odissi), Shovana Narayan and Aditi Mangaldas (Kathak), Priyadarshini Govind (Bharatnatyam), and Raja-Radha Reddy and family (Kuchipudi).

There will also be music presentations by Madhup Mudgal, Shanno Khurana, Meeta Pandit (vocal), Prateek Chaudhri (sitar), Murad Ali (sarangi), along with the fusion band, Advaita. Don't miss the food stalls that bring in the best cuisine from a plethora of restaurants—Delhi O Delhi, Oriental Octopus and The Deck. It is a cultural experience steeped in riches. **by S. Sahaya Ranjit**

The festival will witness a confluence of five dance forms



YASBANT NEGI

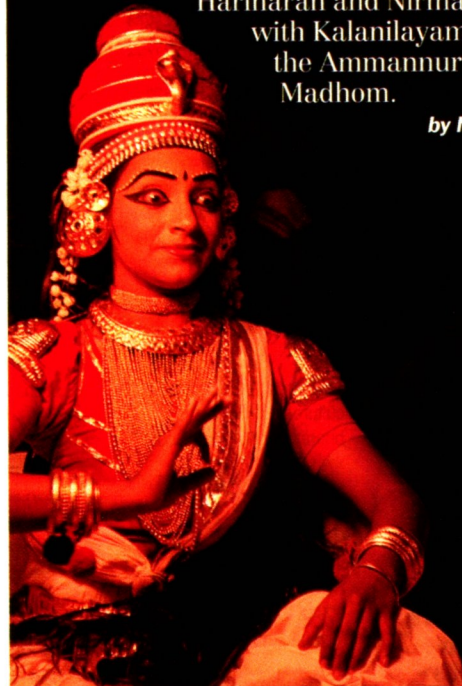
theatre

History Play

THRISSUR Abhinaya Kalari, the acting laboratory of Natana Kairali, presents Kalidasa Natyotsav 2007, a festival of Kalidasa's plays in kuttiyattam—the oldest surviving Sanskrit theatre in the world. Master poet Kalidasa is strangely not a common author when it comes to kuttiyattam performances unlike Bhasa and Kulashekara. The highlight of the festival is the play *Abhijnana Shakuntalam*. The performance will take place over three days starting November 19. Directed by eminent theatre personality G. Venu, the play will feature some of the best kuttiyattam performers like Ammannur Rajaneesh Chakyar, Kapila, Sooraj Nambiar, Kalamandalam

Hariharan and Nirmala Paniker with Kalanilayam Haridas. At the Ammannur Chakyar Madhom.

by Nirmala Ravindran



Kuttiyattam performance of *Abhijnana Shakuntalam*

art

Nature's Palette

DELHI Nature seems to come alive in her paintings in various tonalities—the green leaves, the blues of the sea and sky and the seasons. Kota Neelima's second exhibition *Silver of Time*, depicts the unnoticed facets around us.

The lotus is the main motif in most of her paintings. Her strokes are vibrant and defy



Claims of Water by Neelima categorisation. Also on display are photographs by Anuj Parti. On at The Travancore Palace Gallery. Till November 20.